Zerihun Doda, PhD

Associate Professor of Sociology and Anthropology

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Professional Summary

Associate Professor of Sociology and Anthropology and Senior Faculty Member at Ethiopian Civil Service University (ECSU), serving as Research Director since September 2018. Holds a PhD in Anthropology & Biodiversity Management (specializing in biocultural diversity conservation) from the University of Kent, UK.

With over 28 years of experience in academia, research, training, and consultancy, Dr. Doda has conducted research for entities including the Federal Civil Service Commission, ECSU, The Christensen Fund, UNICEF, and the SNNPR Government.

Key Expertise & Focus Areas:

- Social protection, population dynamics, and sustainable development.
- Peace, conflict, climate change, and traditional environmental knowledge.
- Public service delivery, efficiency, and professional ethics.
- Livelihood, identities, cultural-historical heritages, and gender social justice.

Education

Degree	Field	Institution	Dates	Notes
PhD	Biodiversity Management (Environmental Anthropology & Biocultural Diversity Conservation)	University of Kent, Canterbury, UK	2011 – 2015	
MA	Social Anthropology	Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia	1999 – 2001	Thesis: "Culture & Mental Illness among the Zay of Lake Zway Islands, Ethiopia".
BA	Sociology & Social Administration	Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia	1993 – 1996	**Award:** Outstanding Student of the Year.

Professional Experience

Ethiopian Civil Service University (ECSU) | Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Associate Professor | Research Director | Editor-in-Chief | September 2018 – Present

- **Research Director (March 2021 – Present):** Leads Research Affairs for the university, developing strategy and managing initiatives.
- **Editor-in-Chief (Feb 2019 – Present):** Oversees the *Journal of African Development Studies*.
- **Assistant Professor:** Teaches in the Department of Social Protection Management and provides internal examination and software advisory services for PhD students.
- **Course Management:** Contemporary Discourses in Gender, Climate Change and Conflict, Sociology of Conflict and Peace, Advanced Qualitative Research Methods (CAQDAS), and Ecological Anthropology.

Hawassa University | Hawassa, Ethiopia

Assistant Professor | May 2016 – September 2018 & March 2004 – January 2011

- **Research Leadership (2016-2017):** Chaired the committee to establish a scientific research journal for the College of Social Sciences and Humanities.
- **Editorial Role (2016-2018):** Associate Editor for the University's *Journal of Science and Development*.
- **Instruction:** Taught a wide range of courses including Disaster Risk Management, Urban Sociology, Social Policy Analysis, and Indigenous Knowledge Systems.

Dilla University | Dilla, Ethiopia

Lecturer | September 1996 – May 2004

- Progressed from Graduate Assistant to Lecturer teaching Sociology & Anthropology.
- **Coordinator (2003–2004):** Led the Research and Publication Coordination Office (RPCO) at Dilla College of Teacher Education & Health Sciences.

Research Experience & Projects

Role	Project Title / Focus	Institution / Funder	Dates
Co-Investigator	Enhancing Pro-Environmental Behaviors In Manufacturing Sector	ECSU	Dec 2024 – Present
Principal Investigator	Child Migrant Laborers from Wolayta Zone in Addis Ababa	ECSU	Sept 2024 – Present
Co-Investigator	Teachers' Implicit Ethnic-Based Biases Toward Students	ECSU	Nov 2023 – May 2024
Co-Investigator	Leveraging Character Strength for Job Performance Enhancement	ECSU	Feb 2023 – Nov 2023
Co-Consultant Researcher	Project on Service Delivery and Citizen Satisfaction in Ethiopia: Public Perception Synthesis	Federal Civil Service Commission	July 2021 – March 2023
Principal Investigator	Public sector green and clean working environments and organizational productivity	ECSU Center for Research in Ethics & Integrity	Nov 2021 – Dec 2022
Co-Investigator	Drivers of Corruption in the Ethiopian Revenue Sector	ECSU	Nov 2021 – May 2022
Principal Investigator	Representation and implementation of socio-cultural issues in environmental policy formulations in Ethiopia	ECSU Center for Research in Ethics & Integrity	Nov 2020 – May 2021
Thematic Research Project Leader	Structural fitness and service provision efficiency in public sector organizations	ECSU Environment & Climate Change Management	Feb 2019 – Dec 2020
Co-Consultant Researcher	15-year Strategic Road Map Design: Organizational culture, professionalism, and work ethics	Ethiopian Civil Service Commission	Jan 2019 – Apr 2019
Lead Researcher	Qualitative study of misuses and abuses of malaria protection bed nets in Adami Tulu, Ziway	MalTrial Project / Hawassa University / University of Bergen	Dec 2016 – May 2017

Publications

Journal Articles (2017 – Present)

1. Belda, F., Keno, G. I., Lemessa, A., & **Doda, Z.** (2025). The Course of Industrial Development Influencing Smallholder Farmers' Peace... *Journal of Rural and Community Development*, 20(2).
2. Fufa, Y., ... **Doda, Z.**, et al. (2025). Experience of anthrax outbreak surveillance, preparedness, and response... *Journal of Public Health in Africa*.
3. **Doda, Z.**, & Worku, M. (2023). Public Sector Greenness and Cleanliness in Ethiopia: A Case Study... *Journal of African Development Studies*, 10(2), 75–90.
4. Shete, M., **Doffana, Z. D.**, & Abate, S. M. (2023). The State and Drivers of Corruption in the Ethiopian Revenue Sector. *Journal of Business and Administrative Studies*, 15(1), 15–39.
5. Endris J., Gutema I., **Zerihun D.**, and Abebe L. (2022). Resilience of People Displaced from Ethio-Somali Region and Resettled in Oromia Special Zone Surrounding Finfinne... *African Journal of Social Work*, 12(6), 325–335.
6. Endris Jafer, Gutema Imana, **Zerihun Doda** & Abebe Lemessa (2022). Post conflict-induced displacement: Human security challenges of internally displaced persons... *Cogent Social Sciences*, 8:1.
7. **Doda, Z.** (2021). Socio-cultural Considerations in Environmental Policy Formulation and Implementation in Ethiopia. *Journal of African Development Studies*, 8(2), 38–49.
8. Alemayehu, Dejene and **Doda, Zerihun** (2020). Indigenous Environmental Knowledge of Borana Pastoralists. *Grassroots Journal of Natural Resources*, 3(4): 110-131.
9. **Doffana, Z. D.** (2019). Sacred sites and ancestor veneration in Sidama, southwest Ethiopia: A socio-ecological perspective. *Cogent Social Sciences*, 5(1).
10. **Doda, Z.** (2019). The conservation of African yellowwood tree (Afrocarpus falcatus) in Sidama sacred sites, Ethiopia. *Cogent Social Sciences*, 5(1), 1–17.
11. **Doda, Zerihun**, Solomon, T., Loha, E., Gari, T., & Lindtjørn. (2018). "A Qualitative Study of Use of Long-Lasting Insecticidal Nets (LLINs) for Intended and Unintended Purposes in Adami Tullu..." *Malaria Journal* 17(1):69.
12. **Doffana, Z. D.** (2017). Sacred natural sites, herbal medicine, medicinal plants and their conservation in Sidama, Ethiopia. *Cogent Food & Agriculture*, 3(1), 1365399.

Books & Book Chapters

- **Doda, Z.** (2022). Preface. In A. E. Jensen et al., *The Sidaama* (S. Thubauville & A. Teferra, Eds.). Berlin: LIT.
- **Doda, Z.** (2018). Indigenous Religions, Identity and Biodiversity in Southwest Ethiopia. In S. Thubauville & E. Alemu (Eds.), *Documenting Southern Ethiopia*. LIT Verlag Münster.
- **Doffana, Z.** (2018). The Role of Sacred Natural Sites in Conflict Resolution: Lessons from the Wonsho Sacred Forests of Sidama, Ethiopia. In *The SAGE Handbook of Nature* (Vols. 1–3). Sage.
- **Doda, Z.** (2014). *Ethno-History and Culture study of Ţambaro Nationality*. Addis Ababa: SNNPRS Council of Nationalities & UNDP.
- **Doda, Z.** (2005). *Introduction to Social Anthropology: Lecture Notes*. Hawassa University & The Carter Centre.

- **Doda, Z.** (2005). *Introduction to Sociology: Lecture Notes*. Hawassa University & The Carter Centre.
- **Doda, Z.** (2004). *Teaching Anthropology for Health Extension Workers*. Debub University.

Conference Presentations

- "Indigenous Knowledge Helps Conserve Endangered Trees and Promote Cultural & Livelihood Resilience: Lessons from Sidama, Ethiopia." Jinka University, June 2019.
- "Sacred Natural Sites and Conservation of Wildlife in Sidama, Ethiopia." Mekele University, May 2017.
- "The conservation of Podocarpus falcatus in sacred sites of Sidama, Ethiopia." International Student Conference on Conservation Science, University of Cambridge, UK, March 2014.

Training & Development

Training Facilitated

- **ATLAS.ti Software Training:** For Hawassa University staff (Feb 2022).
- **ATLAS.ti & Report Writing:** For Ethiopian Public Health Training Institute (March 2021).
- **Scientific Research Report Writing:** For Ethiopian Public Health Institute staff (Aug 2019).
- **NVivo / MAXQDA Training:** For Ethiopian Public Health Institute staff (March 2019).
- **NVivo 11 Pro Workshop:** For ECSU and Addis Ababa Bureau of Labor & Social Affairs (Dec 2017).
- **Advanced Qualitative & Mixed Methods:** For Civil Service University faculty (March & Dec 2017).

Professional Development (Received)

- **People Smart Skills:** Christian Leaders Institute (May 2015).
- **Professional Skills (University of Kent, 2014):** Presentation Skills, Being Assertive, Time Management, Teaching with Technology, Networking and Personal Impact.
- **Qualitative Research Methodology Refresher:** Ethiopia (2013).
- **Video Shooting Skills:** University of Kent (2012).
- **The Linkages between Population, Health and Environment:** Ethiopia (2010).

Technical Skills

- **Qualitative Data Analysis Software:** MAXQDA, ATLAS.ti, NVivo.
- **Quantitative Analysis:** SPSS, CSPro, Stata.
- **Reference Management:** Zotero, Mendeley, Citavi, EndNote.
- **Desktop Publishing:** Affinity Publisher, QuarkXpress.
- **General:** Academic/Scientific Writing, Curriculum Design, MS Office Essentials.

Professional Service & Community Engagement

- **Associate Editor:** *Journal of Police Science*, Ethiopian Police University (Since Oct 2022).
- **Reviewer:** *BMC Public Health*, *Cogent Environmental Science*, *Cogent Social Science*, *SAGE Open*, *European Scientific Journal*.
- **Consultant:** Strategic Road Map Design for the Ethiopian Civil Service Commission (Jan–Apr 2019).
- **Organizer:** National Conference on Sacred Natural Sites of Ethiopia (2010).
- **Media:** Finfine FM Radio Interview (Nov 2023), Hawassa University Community FM Radio Interview (Feb 2017).
- **Advisory Service:** Provided advisory service on qualitative methodology, software, and scientific report write-up for Ethiopian Public Health Institute staff.

References

References

Rajindra K. Puri, PhD Senior Lecturer in Environmental Anthropology, University of Kent, UK Email: R.K.Puri@kent.ac.uk | Phone: (+44)-1227-823148

Dr. Ian Bride Durrell Institute of Conservation and Ecology (DICE), University of Kent, UK Email: i.g.bride@kent.ac.uk | Phone: 01227-(82)7872

Dr. Tadesse Berisso Associate Professor of Anthropology, Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia Email: taddesse.berisso@aau.edu.et

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Dr. Eskinder Loha Associate Professor of Epidemiology, Hawassa University, Ethiopia Email: eskindir_loha@yahoo.com